

UNIVERSAL TOKEN SYSTEM · PHASE 4

One surface, one honest name.

This very title rides `--surface-inverse` — the dark panel that used to be confusingly spelled `--bg-dark`.

The `--bg-dark` vs `--dark-bg` fix.

The collision

`--bg-dark` (a dark panel on a light deck) sat one keystroke from `--dark-bg` (the canvas in dark mode) — opposite roles.

surface-inverse

The dark panel on a light deck — title, divider, closing, split rails, code (was `--bg-dark`).

scheme-dark-*

The dark-color-scheme inputs — the values `light-dark()` resolves to in dark mode (was `--dark-*`).

Kept as-is

`--bg`, `--bg-alt`, `--border` are clear and short — renamed nothing for the sake of it.

This panel is --surface-inverse too.

Bookends · title, divider, closing

The whole dark-bookend trio paints one surface token. Reading the component CSS now tells you exactly which dark it means.

And the code panel rides it as well.

```
// --code-bg now resolves through --surface-inverse  
function panel(scheme) {  
  return scheme ≡ "dark"  
    ? "--scheme-dark-*" // the color-scheme inputs  
    : "--surface-inverse"; // the dark panel on a light deck  
}
```

PHASE 4 OF 7 · SEE [ENGINEERING/DECISIONS/2026-06-11-UNIVERSAL-TOKEN-SYSTEM.MD](#)

Surfaces you can read
at a glance.